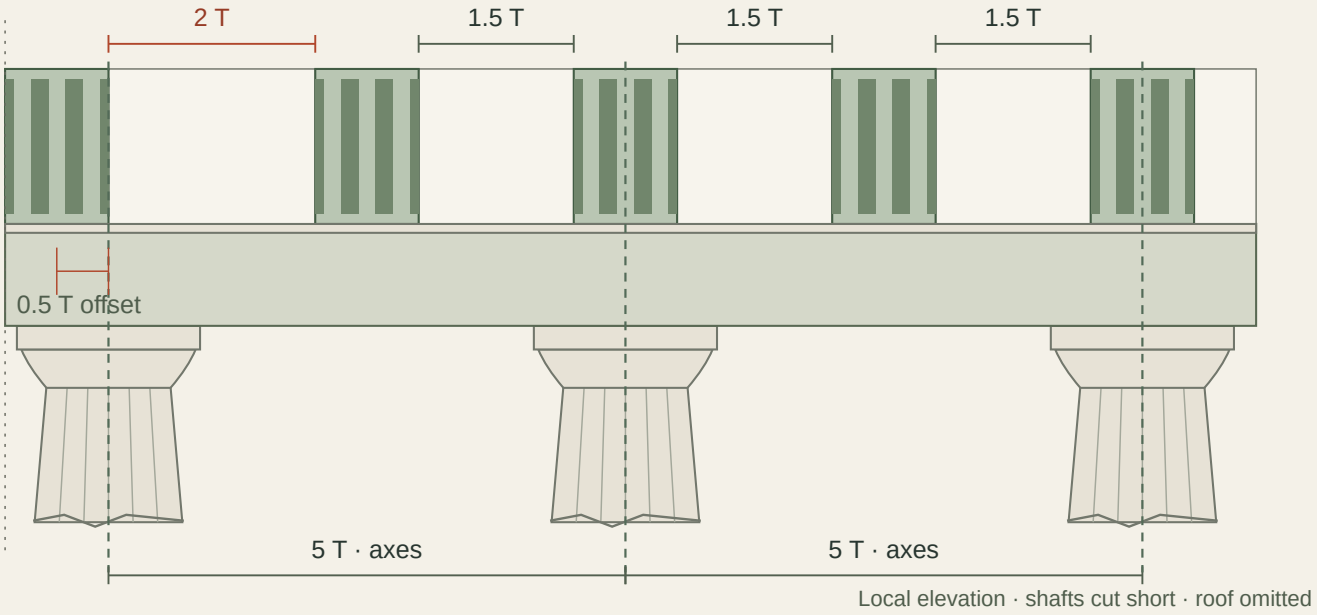
Widen the end metope

Pull the corner triglyph out to the edge and leave the columns in place. The panel beside that triglyph grows wider. The corner triglyph is now off its column’s axis.

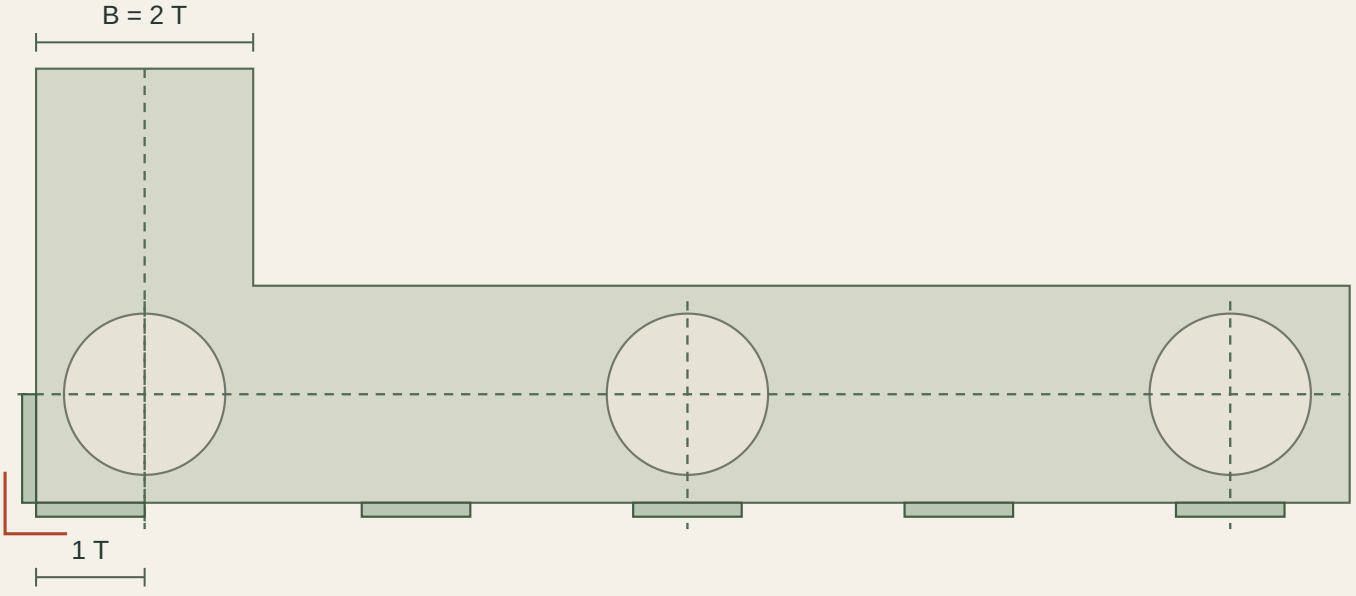
Beam depth B = 2 T; triglyph width T = 1; ordinary metope width and frieze height = 1.5 T.

Front elevation



Local elevation · shafts cut short · roof omitted

Plan from above



The corner column axis lies B / 2 from the outer face. A triglyph at the edge has its centre T / 2 from the corner. The discrepancy is $\delta = (B - T) / 2 = 0.5\ T$.

Measurement	Selected corner	Reference
First metope width	2 T	1.5 T normally
End column bay, axis to axis	5 T	5 T normally
Strip before corner triglyph	0 T	0 at the edge
Corner triglyph off its column axis	0.5 T	0 when aligned

Words attached to the drawing

English	Greek	Latin
Corner	γωνία	angulus
Triglyph	τρίγλυφος	triglyphus
Metope	μετόπη	metopa
Architrave	ἐπιστύλιον	epistylium
Column	κίων	columna

Vitruvius, De architectura IV.3.2

Latin: F. Krohn’s 1912 edition, pp. 82–83; punctuation adapted. English translation made for Gonia.

namque necesse est triglyphos constitui contra medios tetrantes columnarum, metopasque, quae inter triglyphos fient, aeque longas esse quam altas.

For the triglyphs must be placed opposite the centres of the columns, and the metopes between the triglyphs must be as wide as they are high.

The desired regularity: alignment and square panels.

contraque in angulares columnas triglyphi in extremis partibus constituuntur et non contra medios tetrantes.

But at the corner columns the triglyphs are placed at the outermost ends, rather than opposite the centres.

The corner requires a different alignment.

ita metopae, quae proximae ad angulares triglyphos fiunt, non exeunt quadratae sed oblongiores triglyphi dimidia latitudine.

So the metopes beside the corner triglyphs do not come out square, but wider by half a triglyph’s width.

Widening the end panel. His half-triglyph adjustment matches our B = 2T example.

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at qui metopas aequales volunt facere, intercolumnia extrema contrahunt triglyphi dimidia latitudine.

Those who want equal metopes instead contract the end intercolumniations by half a triglyph’s width.

Contracting the end spacing. Vitruvius criticizes both compromises in the following sentence.

Scope and sources

This is an idealized local corner, not a named temple. Two equal perpendicular beams; one intermediate triglyph per normal column bay. Column profiles are illustrative. Roof, sculpture, colour, entasis, structural calculations and whole-building refinements are omitted. The equal-width endpoint is a geometric limit. Timber origins remain debated.

Vitruvius’s half-triglyph adjustment agrees with this geometry at B = 2T, not at every depth. Contracting the end bay does not centre the corner triglyph over its column.

Geometric reference: Mark Wilson Jones, “Doric Measure and Architectural Design 2,” *AJA* 105.4 (2001), pp. 675–713, fig. 2, p. 677. DOI. The drawings here are generated from coordinates.

Scanned Latin edition. Greek vocabulary: LSJ / Perseus, with individual dictionary links in the workshop.

Reopen this exact geometry in Gonia

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